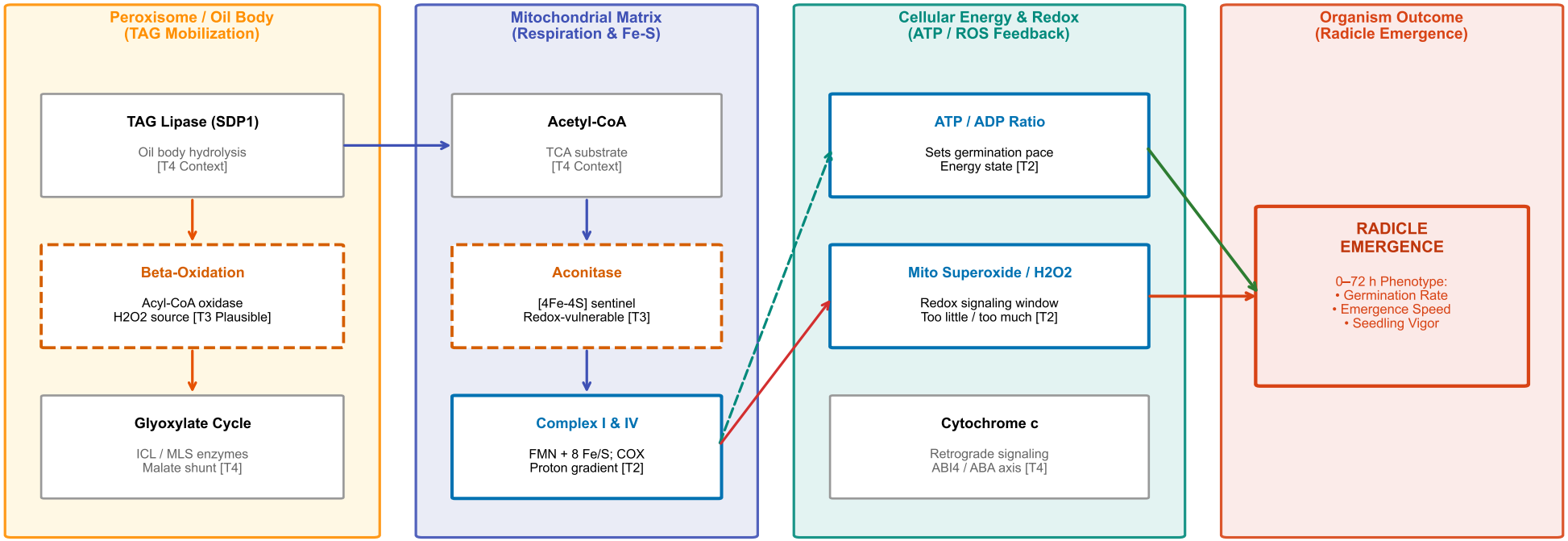
(a) Seed Germination Before Photosynthesis (QBM-06): The 0–72 h Heterotrophic Energy Bottleneck



(b) Evidentiary Tiers & Biophysical Timescale Constraints

T1: Demonstrated Field Effect

Solid black border (2.0 pt); applied field directly measured on biomolecule (e.g. CRY1/2 radical pair)

T2: Inferred from Complex

Solid blue border (1.5 pt); demonstrated for containing pathway (e.g. AOX buffering, Fv/Fm, Ferritin)

T3: Plausible Physical Route

Dashed vermillion border (1.5 pt); spin/quantum mechanism plausible but unmeasured in vivo (e.g. Complex III Qo)

T4: Contextual Scaffold

Hairline grey border (0.8 pt); structural/metabolic scaffold lacking magnetic claim

PHYSICAL TIMESCALE CRITERION FOR MAGNETIC RECEPTION

- Zeeman Precession (50 μT GMF): νL ≈ 1.4 MHz (τL ≈ 714 ns) — Attenuated to <8 kHz in Lunar HMF
- Radical-Pair Spin Coherence: τcoh ~ 1 μs [MATCHES GMF / Attenuated in HMF]
- PSII Primary Charge Separation: ~200 ps [10^6× TOO FAST FOR DIRECT MF EFFECT]
- Complex III Qo Semiquinone-Rieske: Exchange coupling J ~ GHz >> GMF [Refutes runaway ROS leak]

(c) Organellar Bioenergetics & Respiratory Buffering

Chloroplast Photosynthetic Electron Transport (QBM-02)

PSII (P680)

Open: 200 ps
Closed: $^1O_2$ / $^3Chl^*$
[T2 Inferred]

Cyt b6f Rieske

[2Fe-2S] cluster
Q-cycle proton pump
[T3 Plausible]

PSI (P700)

$P700^{\bullet+}$ $A1^{\bullet-}$ pair
FX/FA/FB Fe-S
[T2 Inferred]

Ferredoxin & FNR

NADPH formation
Cyclic flow (PGR5)
[T2 Inferred]

Mitochondrial Respiration & AOX Safety Valve (QBM-01)

Complex I & III

NADH oxidation; Fe-S
Major superoxide leak
[T2 Inferred]

ALTERNATIVE OXIDASE (AOX)

Cyanide-resistant bypass
Bypasses CIII/IV; vents e-
Dampens ROS runaway [T2]

Complex IV (COX)

Heme a3 / CuB
High O_2 affinity
[T4 Context]